

Miners really haven't changed

By STEVE WESTON
Citizen Sportswriter

It's somewhat comforting to realize that in this often tumultuous and tormented world, some things just never change.

One of those is the way University of Texas-El Paso plays college baseball.

Coach Andy Cohen's Miners' tradition of being a treat for an opponents' batting averages and earned run averages, has been carried through to yet another season.

UTEP was smothered twice by coach Jerry Kindall's University of Arizona Wildcats Saturday, 11-4 and 20-1. Coupled with a 23-4 triumph Friday, it was an easy three-game sweep for the defending champion Cats on the first weekend of Western Athletic Conference Southern Division play.

"They didn't get much pitching today, did they?" Kindall replied answering a question with a question.

That was understating the situation.

Arizona ran roughshod over eight UTEP pitchers Saturday and six in the Friday night debacle, causing Miner hurler Roy Stringer to comment that he believed this UA team to be better than last year's 58-6 squad.

It appeared a valid assessment.

In Saturday's opener, third baseman Ron Hassey drove in three runs and right-hander Ron Bell (4-1) limited the Miners to four hits and no runs in seven innings of work.

"I felt fine," said Bell, who appears to have almost completely shaken the restrictions of a sore throwing arm which

has plagued him ever since he hit the UA campus.

Bell received 12-hit support from his teammates, who had riddled the Miners with 20 safeties Friday night.

The Cats came back with a 17-hit offensive attack in the nightcap at Hi Corbett Field, Hassey again driving in three runs. Bob Woodside equaled Hassey in that feat, but both were topped by centerfield

Dave Stegman, who drove in four.

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It made for an easy seven-inning stint for right-hander Steve Powers, who picked up his ninth win against one loss.

Powers struck out nine Miners and surrendered just four hits.

The Miners aided UA's cause with 11 errors over the course of the day, six of them coming in the second game.

In the series, Wildcat pitchers gave up only nine earned runs while the hitters accounted for 54 runs and 49 hits, including nine doubles and five triples.

The twin victories Saturday — witnessed by 1,263 at Wildcat Field in the afternoon and

1,556 at Hi Corbett that night, making for a 4,916 series attendance record — pushed UA's record to 28-6-1 overall and made them 3-0 in league play, of course.

The Miners, who proved susceptible to big innings, dropped to 15-12 and never looked like a team bent on causing any problem in the Southern Division chase.

The sweep elevated UA's dominance in the series with UTEP to 35-4. The Cats visit El Paso, where they own an 18-0 edge, late on.

The Wildcats should meet considerably tougher opposition this weekend when they travel to Albuquerque to meet New Mexico's Lobos.

The Lobos dropped a three-game set to Arizona State in Tempe over the weekend, leaving New Mexico 19-12 and 0-3. But the Lobos gave the Sun Devils (39-6, 3-0) a rugged time in all three games, losing by 4-2, 5-2 and 2-1 in extra innings.

The Wildcats tune up for the New Mexico series by meeting the Pacific Coast League Tucson Toros in a 3 p.m. exhibition game tomorrow at Wildcat Field. The Toros dropped an 8-5 decision to Oakland yesterday in Mesa.

★ ★ ★
Wildcats 20, Miners 1
(Second Game)

Weather gives boost

Major league baseball gets season rolling today

By Associated Press

The weatherman must be a baseball fan . . . at least in Cincinnati.

After more than a week of unseasonably cold weather, the temperature rose into the 50s yesterday and a further warming trend was expected to push the thermometer into the 60s today for the opener of the major league baseball season between the Reds and the Los Angeles Dodgers.

Three more games are scheduled under the lights as the National League begins its 100th campaign and the American League its 75th.

um, including baseball commissioner Bowie Kuhn and Sen. Robert Taft, R-Ohio, who will throw out the first ball.

After viewing the Dodgers and Reds, Kuhn will rush to St. Louis to watch veteran pitcher Bob Gibson begin his final season. Gibson, the winningest active pitcher with 248 victories but trying to bounce back from a sore knee that dropped his record to 11-13 last season, will be opposed by Montreal lefthander Dave McNally, 16-10 with the Baltimore Orioles, who traded him during the off-season.

"I've never thought spring training meant much," said Gibson, who compiled a 2.81 earned run average in six spring outings, "but I've been satisfied with the way I've been throw-